# Joshua Lawson

Ph.D. Candidate
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## Research Interests

My research interests lie at the intersection of empirical asset pricing and market microstructure. My current projects investigate how household demand shapes asset prices, the cost of high-frequency arbitrage, and machine learning methods in finance.

## Education

**Ph.D. in Finance** Aug. 2024–May 2027
University of Tennessee, Knoxville
Haslam College of Business, Expected completion: May 2027.
Committee: Eric Kelley (chair), Daniel Weagley, TingTing Liu, Cristian Tiu

**Graduate Study in Finance** Aug. 2021–May 2024
University of Rochester
Simon Business School.

**M.S. in Mathematics, Applied Track** May 2021
SUNY–Buffalo

**M.S. in Finance, Quantitative Track** Dec. 2020
SUNY–Buffalo

## Publications

- "Crude Oil Futures Prices and Foreign Exchange Markets." (with Md Rafayet Alam, Md Abdur Rahman Forhad, Mohammed Syedul Islam) at ***Applied Economics***, 2023.
- "Speculation and Food-Grain Commodities." (with Md Rafayet Alam, and Xiaoli L. Etienne. ) at ***Applied Economics***, 2021.

## Working Papers

- "The Equilibrium Price Impact of Household Demand." Job market paper.
- "Arbitrage Thresholds and Price Discovery in Dual-Class Equity." (with Cristian Tiu and Dominik Rosch.) Draft available upon request.

## Works in Progress

- "Household Demand, Market Absorption, and Momentum."
- "Do Firm Characteristics Reveal Exposure to Priced Weak Factors?"
- "Expected Growth and Average Utility: A Microeconomic Axiomatization of Ergodicity Economics."

## Presentations

- FMA Doctoral Student Consortium, Tampa, FL, Oct. 2026. Selected presenter, "The Equilibrium Price Impact of Household Demand."
- FMA Annual Meeting, Tampa, FL, Oct. 2026. Presenter, "The Equilibrium Price Impact of Household Demand."
- Brown Bag Seminar, University of Tennessee, 2024, 2026.
- Brown Bag Seminar, University of Rochester, 2022, 2023, 2024.

## Conferences and Workshops

- AFA Annual Meeting, 2027.
- Workshop on Demand System Asset Pricing, with Motohiro Yogo and Ralph Koijen, Summer 2024, Summer 2025.
- Santa Fe Institute, Spring 2024.

- London Mathematical Laboratory, Fall 2024.

## Teaching Experience

**Investment and Portfolio Management (FINC 425)** Spring 2026; Fall 2026
Instructor, University of Tennessee, Knoxville

**Financial Derivatives (MGF 635)** Spring 2021
Instructor, SUNY–Buffalo
Graduate level.

**Financial Derivatives (MGF 435)** Spring 2021
Instructor, SUNY–Buffalo
Undergraduate level.

**Teaching Assistant and Tutor** Sep. 2019–Dec. 2020
SUNY–Buffalo
Derivative Securities, Corporate Finance, Equity Research, Biostatistics, Calculus I/II/III, Linear Algebra, Probability Theory.

## Service

- Quantitative Portfolio Construction with Asset Pricing and Python – an 8 week practitioner focused seminar covering arbitrage pricing theory and models of the stochastic discount factor, Summer 2026.

## Software and Computing

Mu Hat: A comprehensive Python package that replicates the canon of empirical asset pricing.

## Professional Experience

**Chief Investment Officer** 2026
Mu Hat Capital Management, Chattanooga, Tennessee
**Quantitative Consultant** 2024
The Patten Group, Chattanooga, Tennessee
**Equity Research Analyst** 2017
The Patten Group, Chattanooga, Tennessee

## References


Eric Kelley
Goodner Professor of Finance
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University of Tennessee
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